

Gregory Dean Foster, Jr.

TECHNOLOGY DIRECTOR · ENTERPRISE & PLATFORM ARCHITECT

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Technology director with 20 years of writing software, grown from Java developer to enterprise architect. I lead architecture practices, cloud modernization, and reliability transformations for Fortune 500 clients — building the standards, communities, and platforms that outlast the engagement. Still hands-on: Go, Python, Terraform, and Kubernetes across AWS, Azure, and GCP.

Experience

Cognizant

Jul 2022 – Present

Director & Technical Principal

Asheville, NC

Engagement lead for enterprise architecture, cloud security, and reliability transformation. Selected client work:

- **Goldman Sachs** (2026 – present) — Lead architect for a large-scale cloud migration: discovery, migration strategy, and platform reference architecture.
- **Advance Auto Parts** (2025 – 2026) — Lead architect for a completed AWS-to-GCP modernization: discovery, migration strategy, statements of work, and a Terraform-based data & analytics reference architecture.
- **Truist** (2025) — Assessment principal for the platform organization: built the maturity-metrics methodology and ways-of-working framework; delivered the executive readout and recommendations.
- **Freddie Mac** (2025) — Led an SRE transformation assessment: reliability maturity evaluation, an automation roadmap for environment support, and executive materials later shared as an internal case study.
- **Elevance Health** (2023 – 2025) — Established the security-architecture review process for cloud and platform modernization programs; personally conducted hundreds of architecture and security assessments.
- **AbbVie** (2022 – 2023) — Stood up an enterprise-architecture practice for the OUS organization: ADR and ARB processes, a reference architecture built on volatility-based decomposition, an architecture community of practice, and weekly training publications.
- **Cognizant internal** — Founded the consulting org's Security Community of Practice; co-led Cloudboost, a Go service provisioning guard-railed cloud accounts across all three major CSPs (EKS, Helm, Terraform, GitHub Actions).

Nexient

Aug 2021 – May 2022

Delivery Director, DevOps

Asheville, NC

- **GIA** — Delivered the reference architecture (volatility-based decomposition) for the Beacon lab-operations platform plus its DevSecOps runway — GitHub Actions to AWS with templated Terraform modules — and multi-region HA guidance.
- **Fidelity** — Led a junior team through an on-prem Rancher-to-AKS migration: Helm charts, Jenkinsfiles, and centralized Datadog observability, documented end to end as client-ready process flows.
- **Wesco & bench** — Authored an evolutionary-database-design reference enabling dark deployments, feature toggles, and canary releases; trained bench consultants on Azure DevOps, Jenkins, and containerization.

Contino

Oct 2020 – Aug 2021

Lead DevOps Consultant

New Orleans, LA

- **Discover** — Designed and taught engineering dojos — accelerated, hands-on classes in TDD, BDD, contract testing, vertical slicing, value-stream mapping, and CI/CD.
- **The Hartford** — Designed and built private AWS-to-Snowflake connectivity for the data-science org in CloudFormation, with live milestone demos and best-practice training.

DXC Technology

Oct 2018 – Jun 2020

Senior DevOps Engineer

New Orleans, LA

- **Platform DXC** — Built the enterprise Kubernetes platform: standardized builds, Jenkins CI, Vault secrets management, Helm-charted tooling, custom resource definitions in Python, and a serverless API layer via Kubeless.

- **Domain Task Orchestrator** — Designed the DAG-based orchestration service that let platform tools talk to one another, replacing incomplete legacy solutions; integrated it into the platform offering.
- **Mentorship** — Ran ongoing training for junior teams: git, Python, Kubernetes, Docker, API design, and design patterns.

Baker Hughes

Staff Build & Release Engineer

Dec 2016 – Oct 2018

New Orleans, LA

- **Platform Operations Advisor** — Owned build and release for a Predix industrial-IoT platform: Jenkins CI, a fully containerized stack, git-flow change management, semantic versioning, and automated Predix deployments — coordinating every build engineer on the project.
- **Digital Pipeline · Reliance** — Built CI infrastructure and Jenkins Job-DSL automation for two GIS monitoring products; containerized development environments and rewrote legacy build scripts to standard.

Earlier Experience

- **GE Digital**, *Senior Software Engineer* (2016) — Selenium/jBehave test suite, jHipster adoption, legacy refactoring, SOLID mentoring.
- **GE Oil & Gas**, *Senior DevOps Engineer* (2015 – 2016) — CI via shared Jenkins; Chef and Test Kitchen infrastructure for AWS; migration to scripted deployments.
- **GE Capital**, *Senior Java Developer* (2012 – 2015) — STIG-based SecureOS Chef solution; contract-first ESB middleware for online banking.
- **Applied Enterprise Solutions**, *Java Developer* (2012) — WSDL-based services for a Naval inventory program.
- **U.S. Department of Energy**, *Java Developer* (2011 – 2012) — Java migration tooling moving millions of files into SharePoint.

Skills

Languages

Go · Python · Java · Ruby · JavaScript · Bash · Lisp · ~~LaTeX~~

Cloud

AWS · Azure · GCP · Cloud Foundry (Predix)

Platform & delivery

Kubernetes · Helm · Docker · Terraform · CloudFormation · Chef · Vault · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Azure DevOps · Datadog

Practices

Enterprise architecture (ADR · ARB) · Volatility-based decomposition · DevSecOps · SRE · TDD/BDD · CI/CD · Evolutionary database design

Community

Operation Spark

Created and taught the DevSecOps curriculum

2019 – 2021

New Orleans, LA